

Running A Viable Streaming Service As a Public Broadcaster

Nico Mwiya – Chief Commercial Officer
- **NBC**

1. Introduction

1.1 Namibian Broadcasting Corporation

The Namibian Broadcasting Corporation (NBC) is established in terms of Section 2 of the Namibian Broadcasting Act (Act No. 9 of 1991) (also referred to as “the Act”) with the aim to carry on a broadcasting service.

Being a creation of statute, the NBC is limited in its activities and operations to what is provided for in the establishing Act, having regard to other applicable and complementary legislation.



1.2 Vision

To provide 100 percent network connectivity to all the Namibian people on all the NBC platforms through **cost effective broadcasting technology**.

1.3 Values

In fulfilling its mandate NBC is guided by the following values and principles:

- We are audience-focused, and will be responsive to the information, education, development, cultural, language and entertainment needs of all Namibians.
- We are committed to reinforcing the right of all Namibians to freedom of expression and their right to a free media and will ensure that its editorial decision-making is independent from influence by political, commercial, or other significant interests.
- We strive to provide a voice for people across the country and to enable communication between government and its citizens.
- Through programming, we will contribute to Namibia's development goals and to building a dynamic information society through airing rights-based programming.
- We promote an understanding of the shared history while building a common vision for the future;
- We focus on meeting the diverse programming needs of all members of the public and will promote universal access to communication services regardless of race, geography, colour, gender, age, ability, ethnicity, religious affiliation, political inclination or social or economic status. We strive to deliver compelling quality content in a range of languages spoken in Namibia while reinforcing the use of English as the country's official language.
- **We encourage innovation and promote innovative communications approaches using cutting edge technologies that can be replicated particularly across the African continent.**
- We celebrate our cultural heritage and the creative industries in Namibia and strive to provide a



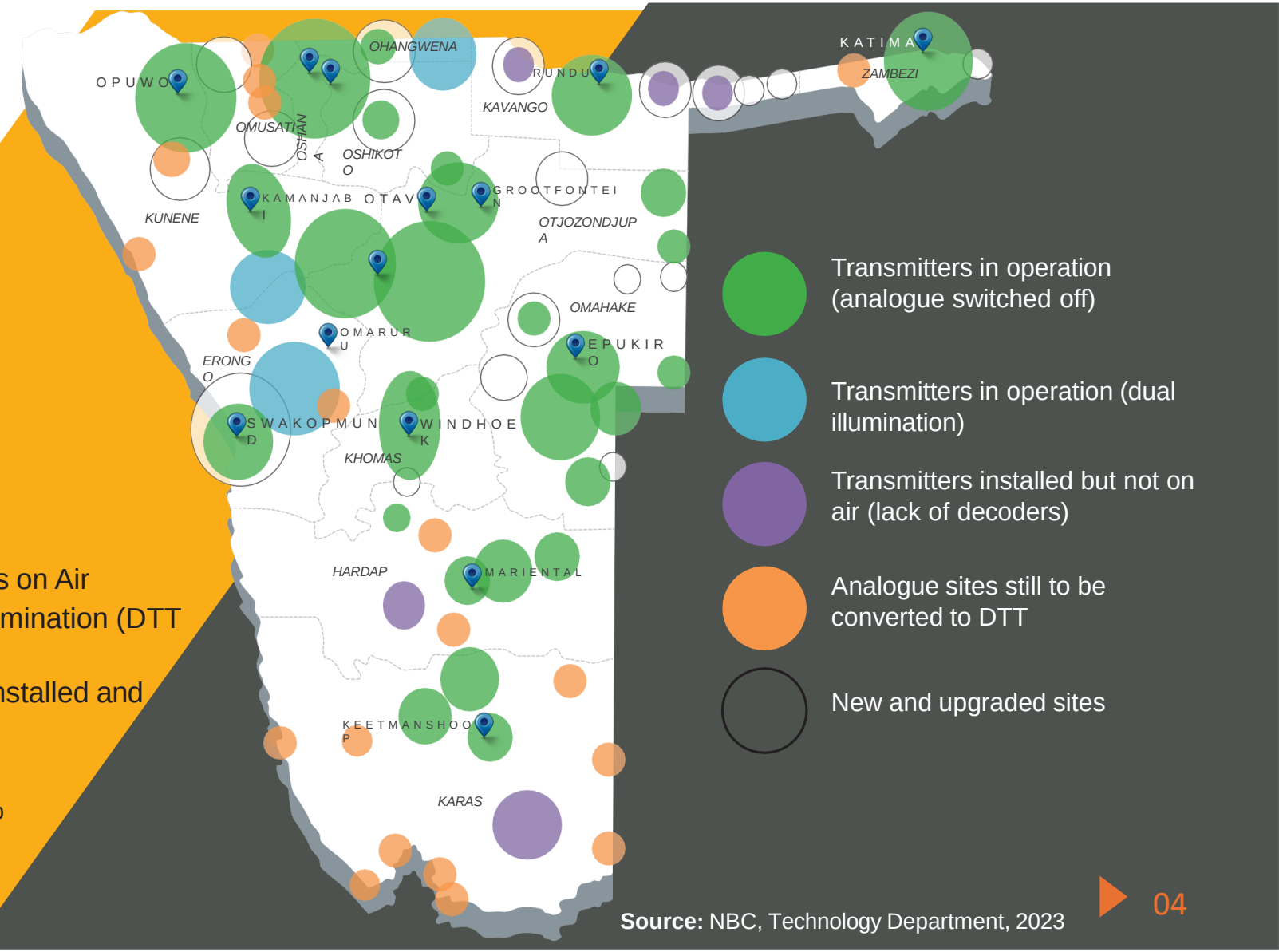
1.4 Mandate

Section 3 of the Namibian Broadcasting Act 1991 (Act No. 9 of 1991) outlines the NBC mandate as follows:

- **To Inform and entertain the public of Namibia**;
- To contribute to the education and unity of the nation, and peace in Namibia;
- To provide and disseminate information relevant to the socio-economic development of Namibia;
- To promote the use and understanding of the English language.

1.5 Network Coverage

- 33 DTT Transmitters on Air
- 2 Sites with dual illumination (DTT + Analogue)
- 7 DTT Transmitter installed and ready for swith on
- Coverage:
  - Television 74.5%
  - Radio 78%



Source: NBC, Technology Department, 2023

2. ICT Sector in Namibia

Geographic Scope



Competitor Scope

- **MTC**
- **TN Mobile**
- Africa Online
- ITN (WTN)
- **Paratus Namibia**
- Vox Telecom, Namibia
- Dimension Data
- Loc8 Mobile
- Others

Customer Scope

- Wholesale
- Government
- Corporate
- Large Enterprises
- Medium Enterprises
- Small Enterprises
- SOHOs
- Residential

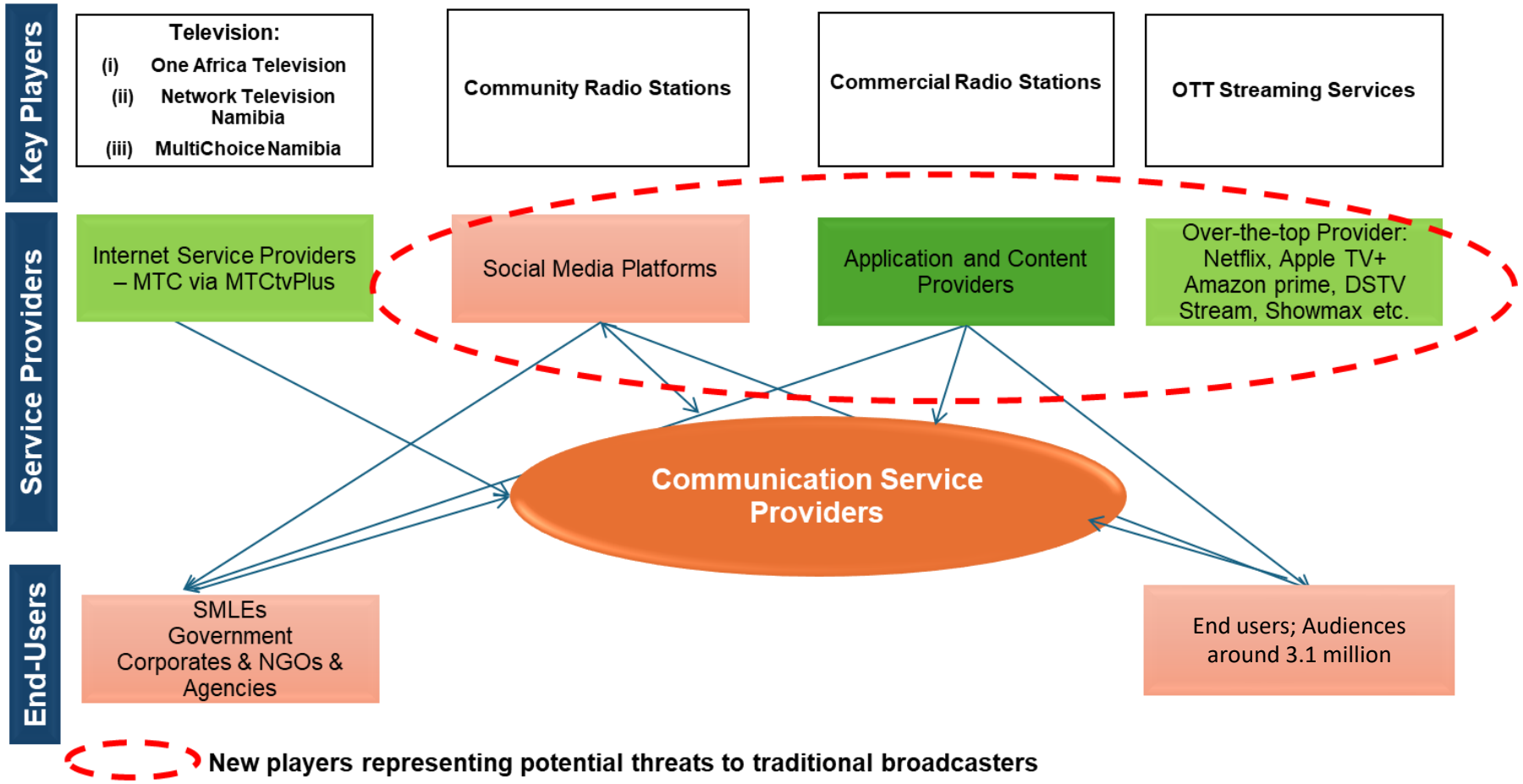
Infrastructure & Towers

- Demshi Investment Holding
- PowerComm

Product & Service Scope

- Fixed Line Voice
  - Postpaid Offerings
  - Prepaid Offerings
- Mobile Communication Services
  - Mobile Voice (GSM/)
  - Mobile Data (3G/4G/G5)
- Data (Layer 2 Transport Services)
  - TDM Offerings
  - Ethernet
- **IP (Layer 3 Transport Services)**
  - MPLS VPN Offerings
  - ADSL/Hotspot/FBB/VSAT
- IT Services
- Infrastructure and Others
  - Site Sharing
  - Collocation
  - Others
  - MVNOs
- FMC – Fixed Mobile Convergence
- 5G – Testing Phase

3. ICT & Broadcast Industry Value Chain and Dynamics



- Broadcasting has evolved from the conversional way to a hybrid model (Satellite and IP).
- The role of broadcasters such as the NBC in the value chain has been tested, mainly due to increasing increasing competition from Over-the-top (OTT) providers and new ecosystem players

4. Drivers & Resources

The following eight key drivers will impact the Namibian ICT market

Key drivers in the ICT market

	Impact		
	2024 – 2025	2024 – 2025	2025 – 2026
Infrastructural developments such as the landing of undersea cables; Equino Capable	Med Term HIGH	Med Term HIGH	Long Term HIGH
Reduction in prices due to competitive pressures will increase uptake of products and services especially after the introduction of 5G	Short Term HIGH	Med Term HIGH	Long Term MEDIUM
Increased mobility and demand for Internet/data applications in consumer and enterprise markets	Short Term HIGH	Med Term MEDIUM	Long Term MEDIUM
Increasing population and shifting demographic patterns	Short Term HIGH	Med Term MEDIUM	Long Term LOW

4. Drivers & Resources Continues

Key drivers in the ICT market

	Impact		
	2024 – 2025	2025 – 2026	2026 – 2027
Economic growth and increasing inflows of foreign direct investments	Short Term HIGH	Med Term HIGH	Long Term HIGH
Government initiatives and direct expenditure geared at improving ICT usage especially in the rural areas; 5G Spectrum Auction.	Short Term HIGH	Med Term HIGH	Long Term MEDIUM
Demand for bundles is growing as consumers crave a simplified experience	Short Term HIGH	Med Term MEDIUM	Long Term MEDIUM
Advancements in fixed and mobile technologies	Short Term HIGH	Med Term MEDIUM	Long Term LOW

5. High level Research

	Total	Erongo	Hardap	Karas	Kavango Total	Khomas + Omaheke	Kunene	Ohangwena	Omusati	Oshana	Oshikoto	Otjozondjupa	Zambezi
Base	*1500*	*105*	*62*	*81*	*159*	*271*	*72*	*164*	*161*	*126*	*128*	*92*	*79*
YouTube	75%	71%	70%	88%	67%	71%	100%	73%	76%	77%	78%	74%	69%
Facebook	48%	57%	74%	56%	35%	51%	55%	53%	44%	48%	35%	45%	40%
Netflix	29%	28%	35%	16%	23%	45%	18%	27%	20%	36%	26%	24%	23%
DSTV Now	24%	30%	17%	12%	26%	23%	55%	13%	24%	15%	22%	26%	40%
Instagram Television	17%	20%	9%	20%	9%	22%	0%	17%	32%	21%	13%	8%	20%
nbc Plus	6%	**8%**	0%	0%	5%	2%	9%	**13%**	**12%**	5%	4%	5%	**9%**
Showmaxx	4%	7%	9%	0%	2%	4%	0%	3%	4%	2%	4%	3%	6%
Apple +	4%	5%	4%	0%	5%	4%	0%	7%	4%	3%	0%	3%	0%
Amazon Prime Video	3%	7%	0%	0%	5%	2%	0%	3%	0%	5%	0%	5%	3%
Hulu	0%	3%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	2%	0%	0%	0%
I don't use any OTT service	10%	14%	13%	4%	16%	7%	0%	10%	8%	8%	17%	8%	17%



6. History of nbcPlus

The NBC launches nbcPlus Mobile Application

Where the OTT Stream of the NBC started:

- NBC's OTT streaming platform, nbcPlus, commenced operations in 2018, with its inaugural presentation taking place at the ICT Summit.
- The preliminary release of the nbcPlus application occurred during the 2017 at the ICT Summit.
- In April 2018, the nbcPlus Mobile App was officially launched by the Minister of ICT. This app was made accessible on both IOS and the Google Play store.
- Within the initial week of its release, the aggregated subscriber count reached **680**.
- Operating on a subscription-based model, prospective subscribers could opt for various plans: **N$30 per week**, **N$89 per month**, **N$600 for 6 months**, and **N$899 for a 12-month** subscription.

6. Challenges Encountered

The NBC encountered fewer challenges in 2018 and these were as per the below;

- **Bandwidth Expenses**: The nbcPlus platform necessitated a significant amount of bandwidth, with the demand increasing alongside the subscription base. Consequently, nbcPlus utilized a 100mbps Point-to-Point internet line.
- **Internet Penetration Rate**: Namibia experienced a penetration rate below 50 percent, despite mobile penetration surpassing 100 percent in the country.
- **Subscription Affordability**: To access nbcPlus, subscribers were required to pay a subscription fee, facilitated through credit or debit card transactions.
- **Data Affordability Concerns**: Many users expressed concerns about the affordability of data usage, making it challenging for a considerable portion of subscribers to manage.
- **Service Level Agreements (SLA):** Operating an OTT streaming platform involves high SLA costs, as a minimum guarantee of 5,000 users is required, contributing to the overall expenses.



7. New Platform

New nbcPlus Platform

- The nbcPlus OTT Streaming Platform underwent a comprehensive revamp, including a redesign of the User Interface (UI).
  - This overhaul was extended to both the nbcPlus Mobile Application and the web browser, referred to as the landing page.

- To ensure the sustainability of the nbcPlus streaming application, a robust infrastructure for hosting and streaming videos was established.
  - This infrastructure includes the implementation of a Content Delivery Network (CDN) to guarantee the swift and reliable delivery of videos to viewers, both VOD and Linear Channels.

- MAM – The nbcPlus Platform is build on the Media Asset Management



8. New Platform

New nbcPlus Platform - Continues

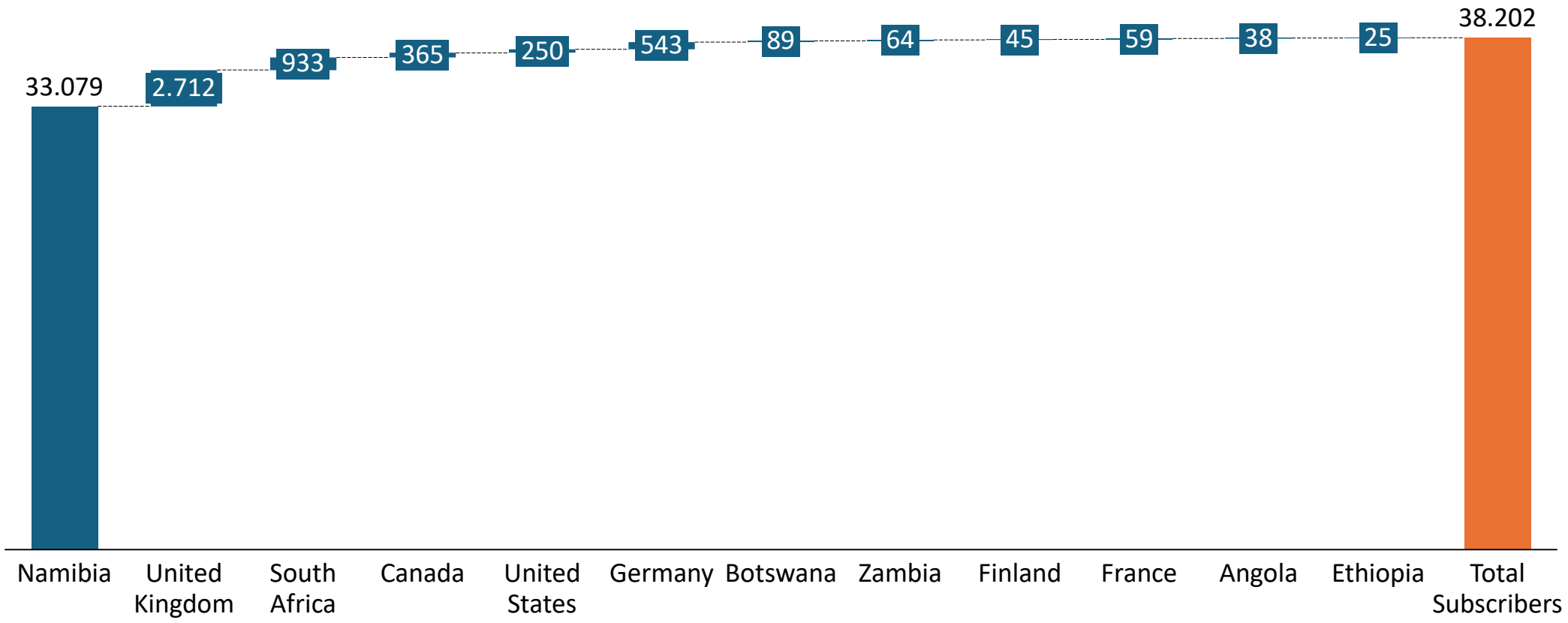
- The nbcPlus OTT Streaming Platform prioritizes security, incorporating a robust system to safeguard user data and prevent unauthorized access to the platform.

- All nbcPlus subscribers are mandated to register before accessing the platform. The registration process entails providing essential information such as;
  - Name
  - Surname
  - Email Address, and Contact Number, ensuring a secure and personalized user experience.



8.1 Subscribers

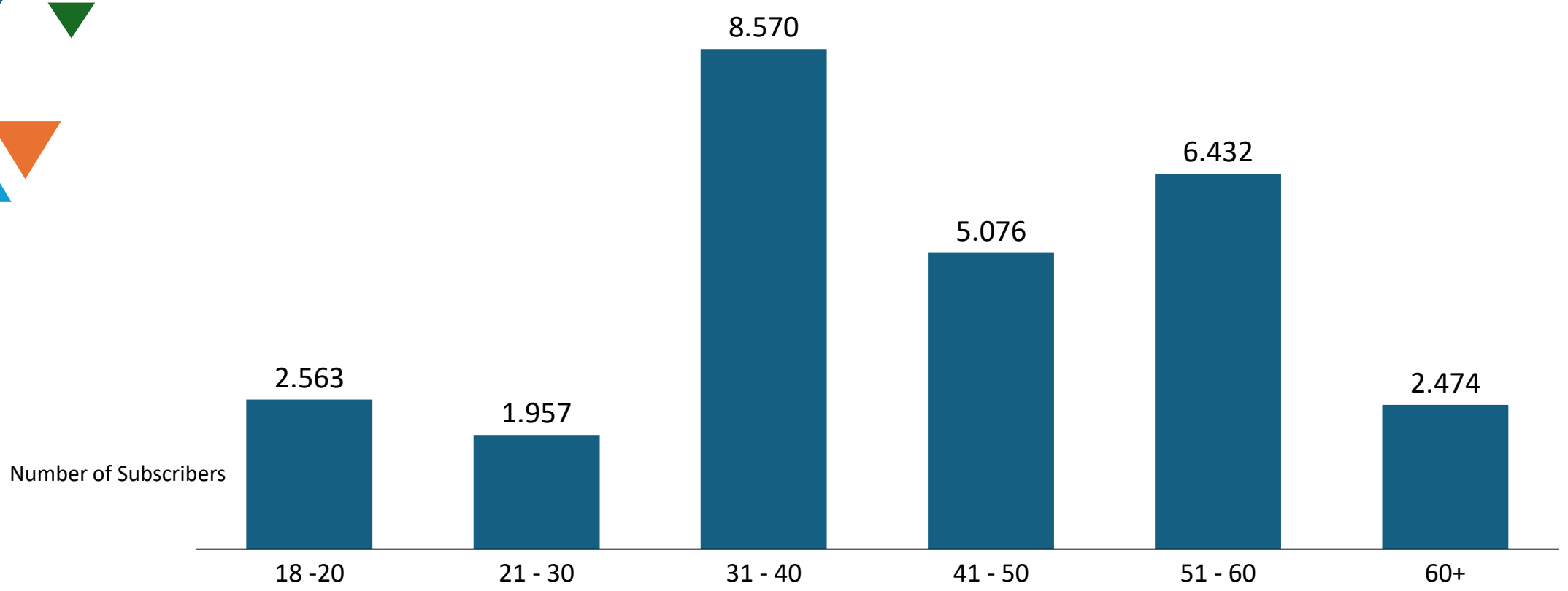
In total, nbcPlus platform has attracted 38,202



Source: nbcPlus Content Management System/MAM 09 September 2024

8.2 Demographic

Most of the nbcPlus subscribers' age group ranges between 31 – 40 years



Source: nbcPlus Content Management System/MAM 09 September 2024

8.3 Success of nbcPlus

Differentiation Strategy

- Streaming has completely changed how media is purchased and consumed.
- With over 300 streaming video services available to consumers and counting, every media and entertainment company is battling for customer attention and entertainment spend.
- The nbcPlus App focus on three critical pillars when it comes to its customer acquisition strategy; brand touchpoints, customer journey and customer experiences.
- The key strategic intention for nbcPlus is customer engagement, retention and experience.



8.4 What makes good content

- The Miss Namibia event was streamed by over 100,000 viewers within 3 days on YouTube and 45,000 on the nbcPlus platform.
- News and Current affairs programs include In the Community, Wheels of Justice, and News Review etc.
- Other content includes Whatalife Style, Whatagwan, and On the Street with City Police, among others.
- In partnership initiatives, the NBC has collaborated with MultiChoice Namibia to produce 13 local films, which are yet to be broadcasted by the NBC.
- Broadcasting in all the languages on 11 radio stations



8.5 nbcPlus Goals

Goals

- Attract and retain a health minimum of 20,000 minimum per month. Currently we have a health viewership of 55,000 per month.
- Offer a one stop shop mobile application with both VOD and Linear Channel (Radio and Television).
- High quality and futuristic in App Design as a differentiator from the other Over the Top Services.
- Improve and enhance the nbcPlus Brand through exceptional customer services.



9. Strategy



Strategic Intent

- nbcPlus is defined by 2 strategic intent; Engagement and Retention
  - Driver more customer engagement through new local content via the VOD capability and platform; this creates service stickiness, builds relationship, increase retention and eventually customer lifestyle value;
  - The aim is to increase the customer retention by 10 percent on month to month;
- Customer strategy is broken down in the following pillars;
  - Customer Seamless experience
  - Customer engagement
  - Customer retention

10. Next Steps

Key Activities for the nbcPlus Application

Engagement Progress

Key Activities	Details	Duration
1 Hosting at the Data Centre	Currently, the nbcPlus environment is hosted the NBC HQ, therefore, CDN will be hosted at the Data Centre – locally.	Beginning of October 2024
2 Redundancy	The NBC has developed an architecture that includes a redundancy system, which will mirror the current nbcPlus platform to ensure continuous functionality.	End of May 2024
3 Develop Rate Cards for in App Adverts	nbcPlus App is provided to the Namibian population for free. In order to sustain and generate revenue, we have developed the rate card to for prospect clients to advertise on the App.	End of August 2024
4 nbcPlus life-style	nbcPlus App is provided to the Namibian population for free. In order to sustain and generate revenue, we have developed the rate card to for prospect clients to advertise on the App.	Q1 of 2025

11. New Platform – Under development



Thank You



nbc Plus
It's global

Back Home